

PantriHub – Project Report

Bushra Alkhateeb, Ethan Behl, Thomas Needham, Ishankumar Vimalkumar Patel, Shivam
Jigneshbhai Soni

Faculty of Engineering and Applied Science,

University of Regina

ENSE281 – Software Engineering Management

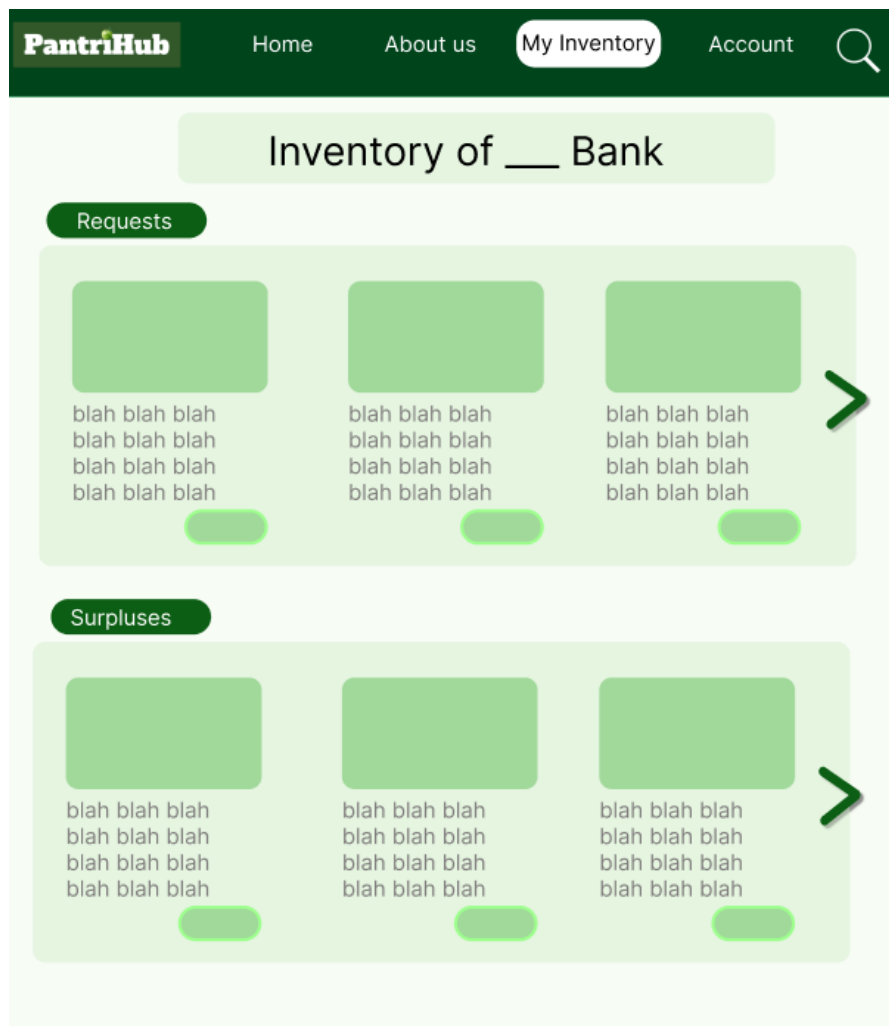
Dr. Tim Maciag

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Project Progress and Finalization:

What was progress like?

Progress wasn't nearly as linear as it should have been and instead happened in short bursts. The progress initialization went well and was quite simple to do. This was still when we were figuring out what the project was going to be, which there were luckily never any arguments about. When designing the actual pages, we all made low effort prototypes to see everyone's ideas about what we could make. After looking at all the designs, we made the decision to create a card-like viewing experience. Although we changed this later on in the project, this is what the inventory page originally looked like:



1.1 Inventory Page Idea

We had to change the visuals because going through a large number of items would be difficult for a car-like view, so we saved it for the dashboard only. We realized this both because the professor mentioned it, and someone who filled out our form also mentioned it. This was also a very similar design to the shared dashboard, so the inventory page being different makes sense.

We also had an about page that we designed at the same time as this page, which was eventually cut from the final project all together. This is because although it might be nice to have, it isn't useful, and with our time being limited later on, we decided to cut it. Most people who have access to the site anyway would be employees who already know what it's for, so that

makes it less useful. This is what our idea was for the about page:

Who We Are

PantriHub

Description here



Who We Are

PantriHub

Description here



1.2 Scrapped About Page

After this, our design phase was over, and we started coding the pages into reality. At first, we didn't get much done due to most of us not being able to work on it. Up until activity 3, we did not get much done. We had completed maybe a few .html documents and got started on the backend, which was not a lot considering the time we had to work on it. Despite the low productivity, the pages themselves were well done, and the work was well documented. The project never lacked any documentation in the code, and it was always quite clear about what was going on. However, here is where the short bursts of progress were going to hurt us, as the deadline was approaching sooner than we had hoped.

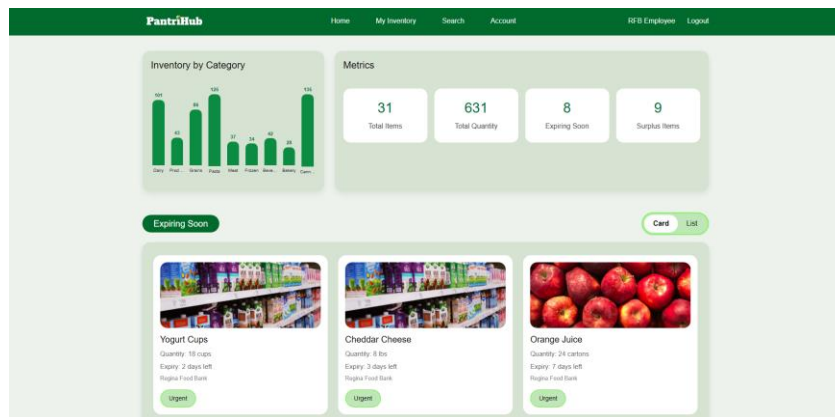
Final Design and Implementation:

When activity 4 came along, we needed to pick up the pace, since we had been informed during our presentation that our progress was lackluster. Due to us being behind and having short bursts of progress, we were worried that we wouldn't finish in time. Some of us had much less time and much less experience working on things than others, so the workload wasn't completely balanced. A few days before the deadline, we had to completely overhaul the GitHub layout, since it didn't work to run the code quite yet. After doing that, progress was much better, and we ended up finishing with time to spare. Even after rushing to get everything finished, we decided that it would be a good idea to not only host the server locally, but to set it up so anyone could look it up online. This helps not only us to see what we accomplished, but also so we don't need to send the files to anyone who wants to try the product out for themselves. The final product ended up being complete with login/logout, correct CRUD implementation for any food items that may be needed, a shared dashboard between all food banks, and a search and filter option to be able to quickly find any item needed. Out of all of these, the shared dashboard is the one that is going to be the most important for food banks to see, and it looks like this:

1.3 Shared Dashboard – Card

This dashboard did not undergo many changes since we first pitched the idea at the start of the project, so we knew what it was going to look like for a while. This was always the core idea for the entire software, so we had to make sure it was easy to see what each item is, which is

why there are pictures of the food. If the user prefers to see a list format, there is an option to change it to see more foods at once, but without the pictures, shows by this next image:



1.4 Shared Dashboard – List

The shared dashboard also sorts items based on expiration dates and surpluses, marking them as urgent or surpluses. We also have a search page, which looks like this:

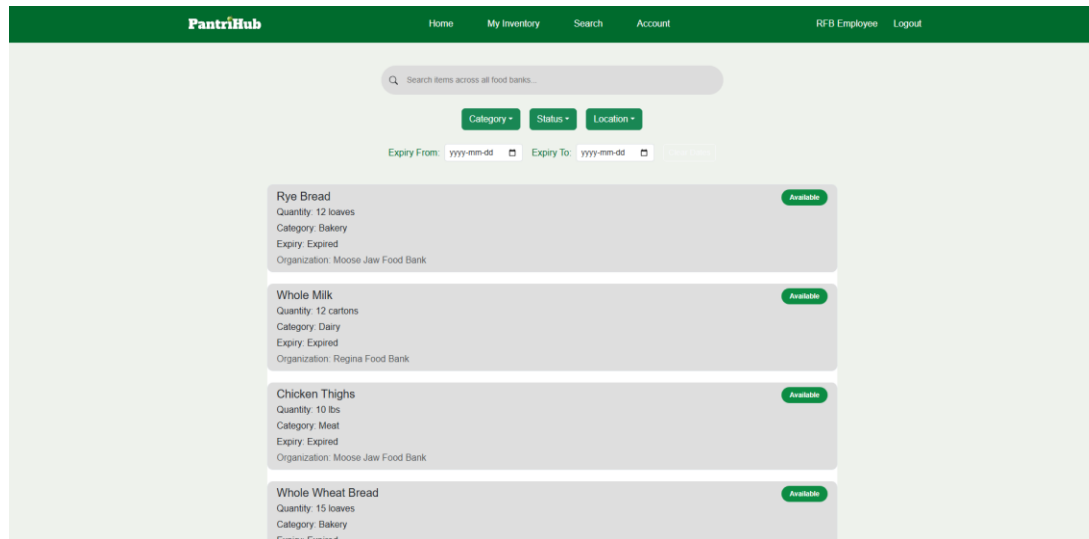
The screenshot shows the search page in the PantriHub application. It features a green navigation bar at the top with links: Home, My Inventory, Search, Account, RFB Employee, and Logout. Below the navigation bar, the page is divided into two main sections. The left section, titled 'Expiring Soon', shows a list of food items with their respective quantities, locations, and expiration dates. Each item has a green 'Urgent' button below it. The right section, titled 'Card List', shows a list of food items with their respective quantities, locations, and expiration dates. Each item has a green 'Urgent' button below it. A toggle switch at the top right of this section allows switching between 'Card' and 'List' views.

Item	Quantity	Location	Expiration	Status
Yogurt Cups	18 cups	Regina Food Bank	2 days left	Urgent
Cheddar Cheese	8 lbs	Regina Food Bank	3 days left	Urgent
Orange Juice	24 cartons	Regina Food Bank	7 days left	Urgent
Eggs	5 cartons	Regina Food Bank	1 days left	Urgent
Butter	6 lbs	Moose Jaw Food Bank	2 days left	Urgent
2% Milk	20 cartons	Saskatoon Food Bank	Available to share	Surplus

1.5 Search Page

This function is to find any food item easily, without having to go looking on the inventory page. It has many sorting options, such as by category, by expiration date, by status, by location, and finally, a search bar to search any name item. The search page is a dedicated page instead of just a bar on the header because it's something the employees will use often enough that it deserves its own page. It also allows lots of filtering, which just a search bar cannot do on

its own. Every page on this site matters and is integral to the reason we made it, to make navigation easier.



1.6 My Inventory Page

Finally, as the last page, we have the inventory page. This is the page where items can be created, updated, and deleted. Every item in its respective food bank can also be viewed here, marked as surplus, low stock or available. It is sorted by expiration date to ensure the most urgent items are viewed first. This page makes it easier to look at urgent things that need to be taken care of. It is also the place where items can be managed, so if an item is used or moved, items can be easily edited, deleted, or even added. Pressing the add item button will bring up an overlay asking for details of the item to be added. The inventory page looks like the following:

FantriHub

Home

My Inventory

Search

Account

RFB Employee

Logout

My Inventory

+ Add Item

Name	Quantity	Unit	Category	Expiry Date	Status	Actions
Whole Milk	12	cartons	Dairy	4/9/2026 (Expired)	Available	EditDelete
Chicken Breast	12	lbs	Meat	4/9/2026 (Expired)	Available	EditDelete
Apples	10	lbs	Produce	4/10/2026 (0d)	Available	EditDelete
Ground Beef	15	lbs	Meat	4/10/2026 (0d)	Available	EditDelete
Eggs	5	cartons	Dairy	4/11/2026 (1d)	Low Stock	EditDelete
Yogurt Cups	18	cups	Dairy	4/12/2026 (2d)	Available	EditDelete
Cheddar Cheese	8	lbs	Dairy	4/13/2026 (3d)	Low Stock	EditDelete
Orange Juice	24	cartons	Beverages	4/17/2026 (7d)	Available	EditDelete
flour	1	lbs	Grains	4/21/2026	Low Stock	EditDelete
Frozen Peas	20	bags	Frozen	7/6/2026	Available	EditDelete
Basmati Rice	40	bags	Grains	10/4/2026	Surplus	EditDelete
Spaghetti	35	packs	Pasta	10/24/2026	Surplus	EditDelete

1.7 Add Item Overlay

It asks for the name of the item, the quantity, the units, category, expiration date, and status. With the time allotted, we were unable to account for any errors the user makes, so if something is misspelled, or is placed in the wrong category, there is nothing in place to fix that.

PantriHub													
Home		My Inventory		Search		Account							
RFB Employee		Logout											
My Inventory													
+ Add Item													
Name	Quantity	Unit	Category	Expiry Date	Status	Actions							
Whole Milk	12	lbs	Dairy	4/9/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
Chicken Breast	12	lbs	Meat	4/9/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
Apples	10	lbs	Produce	4/10/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
Ground Beef	15	lbs	Meat	4/10/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
Eggs	5	cartons	Dairy	4/11/2026	Low Stock	Edit Delete							
Yogurt Cups	18	cups	Dairy	4/12/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
Cheddar Cheese	8	lbs	Dairy	4/13/2026	Low Stock	Edit Delete							
Orange Juice	24	cartons	Beverages	4/17/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
flour	1	lbs	Grains	4/21/2026	Low Stock	Edit Delete							
Frozen Peas	20	bags	Frozen	7/6/2026	Available	Edit Delete							
Basmati Rice	40	bags	Grains	10/4/2026	Surplus	Edit Delete							
Spaghetti	35	packs	Pasta	10/24/2026	Surplus	Edit Delete							

Item Name

Quantity

Unit

lbs

Category

Dairy

Expiry Date

2026-04-25

Status

Available

Cancel

Save Item

Project Reflection:

What were the goals of the project? Were goals achieved?

The initial goal of our project is to create a product that aims to reduce food waste, by providing food banks with a common inventory dashboard which they can communicate within each other about their inventory then to share or exchange items as needed by each bank. The shared dashboard is also to improve bank inter communication. We anticipated our website, to allow food banks staff to add, remove, and update their inventory items they wish to give away. As well as providing a quick way for banks to find contact of each other to share inventory between them. We believe we achieved our goals. There are features within our project that we were able to accomplish, such as the CRUD features, the shared dashboard, the searching and filtering, and the user login with email/password. Although there are other features that were within our goals, we were not able to explore all of them. Some of the features that we wanted to explore but never did were a landing page explaining what this was about and what it did, and requests from other food banks that may be low on some foods, and has a surplus for other foods.

What feedback did you receive throughout? How did feedback impact/change project decisions (if at all)?

Initially we had the idea of creating a landing page, but when we pitched it to our professor he told us to think about how the addition of a landing page will achieve any of our project goals. Then, after further discussions with the team, we agreed upon not considering that feature and only focus on what can achieve and improve our envisioned MVPs and what serves our set goals.

Also, when working on the project we faced many issues with time and schedule conflicts, we got some motivation and feedback from our professor to work on time management and prioritize our work to achieve our goals. After that feedback, we quickly got to work and made real steps to help with time management in order to progress in our work.

How did you overcome obstacles and frustrations?

We overcame obstacles and frustrations thrown in our way by communication, understanding and action. As the same goes for any project, our team had some issues with communication and some time management issues. These obstacles hindered our way to work on the project and make progress with any completed work. We faced these obstacles by first communicating the situation at hand and our needs to overcome it. Then we tried our best to understand why these obstacles occurred in order to not repeat them again. Lastly and most importantly, we had to take action even at times where that was difficult. We knew what we had to do, so we took all the necessary actions to reach our goals. If a group member is absent we made sure that another fills their role so that we don't have gaps in our team. Another obstacle we faced was our limited coding skills, which hindered our way sometimes. We overcame this by using the same method of communication, understanding, and action. With the endless resources out there, we were able to use them effectively and usefully to learn new skills and integrate them into our project.

How did you feel about this project (as a whole)? What did you like about it? What did you dislike about it?

At the beginning of our project, as a team, we felt very good about how the project was going. We really liked the core idea of our project and how its impact is vital and crucial in today's world. We liked how at the beginning the project was centered and focused on documentation. We believe that was a good way to begin any project as it made things later on organizable and traceable. We wished the coding and constructing stage of our project was a longer period than what was essentially given. The execution stage is probably one of the most important stages of a project, therefore it requires more time to implement. If more was given, we believe we would have spent a longer amount of time exploring other options of design, more time for feedback, etc.

What is your team most proud of with respect to the work accomplished in this project (again, as a whole)?

We were proud of what we accomplished given the time, obstacles, and our limited skills. We believe with our limited skills in coding, as many of us this is their first time being introduced to the languages used in this project, we were able to create something functional. Many of us, especially with backend, had to learn new things in order to make things work and function as anticipated, and that is something to be proud of. We are also proud that despite being quite behind at the beginning of activity 3, we pushed through to the end and finished all our previously decided goals.

What did you learn about yourself as you collaborated and worked on this activity (individually and as a team)

Some of the things we learned about ourselves as a team is the importance of teamwork and communication. Sometimes, when trying to complete some tasks, teamwork was not the most optimum which hindered our progress most of the time. The next thing we learned is the importance of concise and specific communication to inform and communicate our needs and situations.

We also learned the importance of time management and using our time wisely and with awareness knowing deadlines are around the corner. We learned not to repeat these same mistakes even in future projects.

It's also important to note the importance of using real user feedback, and not just assuming that everyone will like and understand our design. Had we not taken the advice we were given, our product wouldn't be nearly as good as it is now. Feedback helps to make things better, even if it means accepting that you are wrong.

Something else that we had to learn was that getting the project done was our number one concern, and that not everything had to be perfect. Our software application was nowhere near perfect, but it works, and that's what matters. It's better to decide to stop and finish than never finish it, trying to make it perfect.

The last thing we learnt is that no matter how skilled you are, communication is a necessary component to working as a team. A team that works well together will always make a better product than a team with skilled coders, but don't work well together.

How will you use (or not use) what you have learned/experienced in this activity going forward?

We believe all stages and experiences in life are an opportunity to learn more about ourselves, grow, and improve. This experience was one of them too. We will use the good of what we have learned in this experience and pass it to other experiences going forward. At the same time, the mistakes we did in this experience will not follow us to the next ones. We will use what we have learned in this project of time management, communication and skills in other projects in the future.